

SANGJUN (SAMUEL) Ko

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Master of Science in Statistics

Bachelor of Science in Statistics (CGPA: 3.92/4.00)

Champaign, Illinois

August 2025 - May 2027 (Expected)

January 2023 - May 2025

- Mathematics Minor
- Coursework: Applied Bayesian Analysis, Data Science Programming Methods, Advanced Data Analysis, Statistical Modeling II, Statistical Data Management, Statistics and Probability II, Statistical Consulting, Elementary Real Analysis, Linear Algebra

WORK EXPERIENCE

STAT107 Data Science Discovery

Undergraduate Course Assistant

Champaign, Illinois

August 2023 - Present

- Assist over 300 students with fundamental data science concepts through interactive labs
- Manage Git for learning platform modifications, benefiting 1000+ students; create, edit, and proofread course materials
- Collaborate with a team of 100+ staff and 2 professors in weekly meetings

STAT443 Professional Statistics

Undergraduate Course Assistant

Champaign, Illinois

January 2025 - Present

- Grade assignments and provide feedback to 20+ students on statistical analysis and consulting using Canvas LMS
- Act as a client in mock projects, simulating real-world consulting challenges

Applied Technologies for Learning in Arts & Sciences

AI/ML Intern Team Leader

Champaign, Illinois

January 2024 - December 2024

- Lead a team of 5 interns and collaborated closely with 3 managers in weekly meetings
- Built ML models with 100,000+ data points using Python and advanced techniques like XGBoost and BERT

KM Internacional S.A.

Intern

Managua, Nicaragua

May 2023 - August 2023

- Oversaw comprehensive inventory management and streamlined administrative tasks for a small textile company
- Lead a team of three workers to achieve a 98% accuracy rate in record-keeping and a 15% reduction in operational costs

PROJECTS/AWARDS

Graduation Prediction Model

September 2024 - December 2024

- Increased AUC score from 0.65 to 0.82 by reducing noise in the dataset through feature engineering and outlier removal across 50,000+ student records
- Built a Streamlit interface with 12 key predictors for real-time predictions for university administrators

3rd Place, 2024 CIC Student Paper Challenge (Columbia University)

September 2024

- Analyzed the socioeconomic and mental health impacts of COVID-19 in Mexico, identifying that 42% of females and 40% of young adults faced job loss
- Proposed interventions to support vulnerable groups through geospatial and statistical analysis

Paraphrase Detection

July 2024

- Achieved 90%+ accuracy in paraphrase detection using BERT, RoBERTa, and SBERT models on the MRPC dataset
- Developed a Gradio interface for real-time detection for easier evaluation of textual similarities

SKILLS

Languages: English (Fluent), Spanish (Native), Korean (Native), French (Basic), Chinese (Basic)

Computer: Python (Advanced): Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn, TensorFlow, NLTK, Matplotlib, Seaborn, BERT, Random Forest, XGBoost, Gradio
R (Intermediate): Tidyverse, ggplot2, dplyr, caret

Git (Intermediate), SAS (Intermediate), Tableau (Basic), SQL (Basic), Office (Advanced)

Certificates: Data Science DISCOVERY, Data Science Certificate, Coursera Business Analytics Certificate

COMMUNITY SERVICE AND EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Consultant in Illinois Business Consulting

September 2024 - December 2024

- Collaborating with interdisciplinary teams to deliver strategic solutions for real-world business challenges, including market analysis, operational optimization, and growth strategy, for clients ranging from Fortune 100 companies to nonprofits